IRON MAN MARK V ARMOR



"The suit itself is a living, evolving, piece of technology. I think, at last count, he was on his twenty-seventh or twenty-ninth version in the comic books, of the Iron Man suit," says Kevin Feige. Iron Man has been tinkering, and updating, his armor for decades now, but one of the oddest innovations—at least to those who aren't familiar with the comic—may be the so-called "Suitcase Suit."

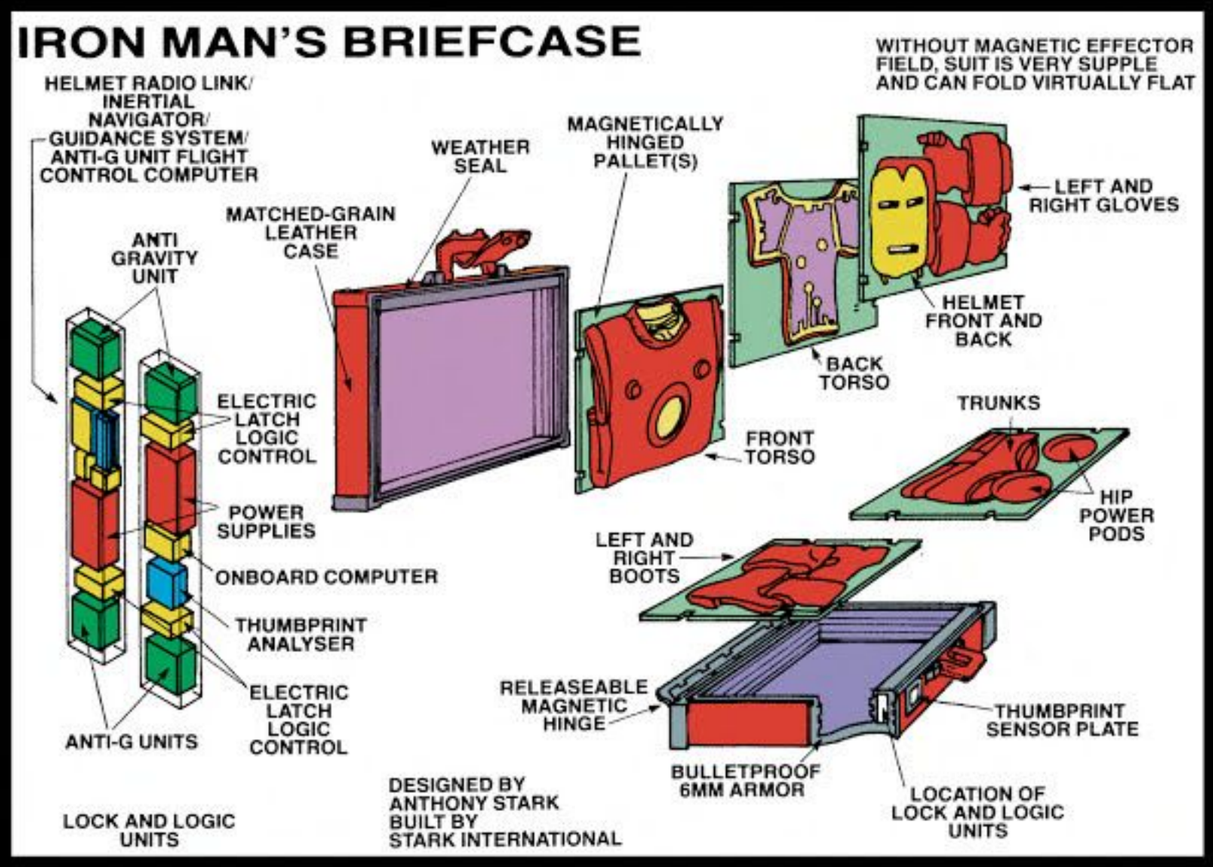
"The suitcase, as a carrying device, went right back to the beginning," says Tom Brevoort. When Tony Stark built the original Iron Man armor, he escaped from his evil captors and walked off into the sunset. But by the next issue, he was back in America and carrying the armor (other than the chest plate that kept his heart beating) in a small suitcase. "In the world of 1964," Brevoort elaborates, "every businessman had their briefcase, but what if that briefcase had this superpowered thing inside of it?" This added to the wish-fulfillment aspect of the hero.

It also allowed him to be mobile, and that was a key concern for the filmmakers when it came to Iron Man 2. "One of the things that makes Iron Man interesting, but also difficult, is the fact that you have this really elaborate suit-up sequence," explains Ryan Meinerding.

"So, realistically, the only place he can become Iron Man is back at the garage. The suitcase suit was sort of born out of the concept of wanting to make sure that if he's around the world, he can still be Iron Man and not have to travel back to Malibu and jump in the Iron Man suit."

"We were talking about the suitcase suit in the first one," says Jon Favreau, "but it felt like such a technological leap, because you didn't really buy it—like, in the comic books, it was somewhat silly. But there's something cool about taking something that's silly and finding a way to justify it and make it actually work, so that you can sort of have your cake and eat it, too.

"The real trick is, how do you make something that's ridiculous in the comic book actually plausible in our film, and how far can we stretch it before we break the tone?"



This image of Iron Man's briefcase, which he used to carry his armor, originally appeared in The Official Handbook of the Marvel Universe #15 (1984).

Art by Don Heck (left), Eliot R. Brown (right).